
Hated Into Being

Discrimination, Threat, and the Making of LGBTQ+ Linked Fate

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The Broader Project

- The Dissertation:
- Coalition cohesion in the LGBTQ+ community:
 - Is it analytically viable?
 - Is it politically meaningful?
 - What mechanisms shape its maintenance and cohesion?
- Chapter 1: Viability and Meaning
- Chapters 2 and 3 (this one): Meaning and Mechanisms

The Puzzle & The Gap

- Discrimination > Higher Linked Fate
 - Finding consistent across marginalized communities
- Scholars rarely distinguish between types of discrimination
- A hate crime, a discriminatory law, a family member rejecting you are all discrimination
 - They differ in who they target, how they're perceived, and what threat they signal
- Question becomes: Does the *type* matter? Are all threats equal?

A Synthetic Framework Approach

- Minority Stress Theory (Meyer 2003)
 - Stigma-related stressors are psychologically meaningful for sexual and gender minorities
 - Continuum of distal stressors (external) to proximal stressors (internal)
- Integrated Threat Theory (Stephan, Ybarra, & Rios 2009)
 - Perceived threat carries real consequences, regardless of objective conditions
 - Provides structure for categorizing responses to group vs individual level threats
- MST tells us threats are real; ITT predicts which threats activate group consciousness

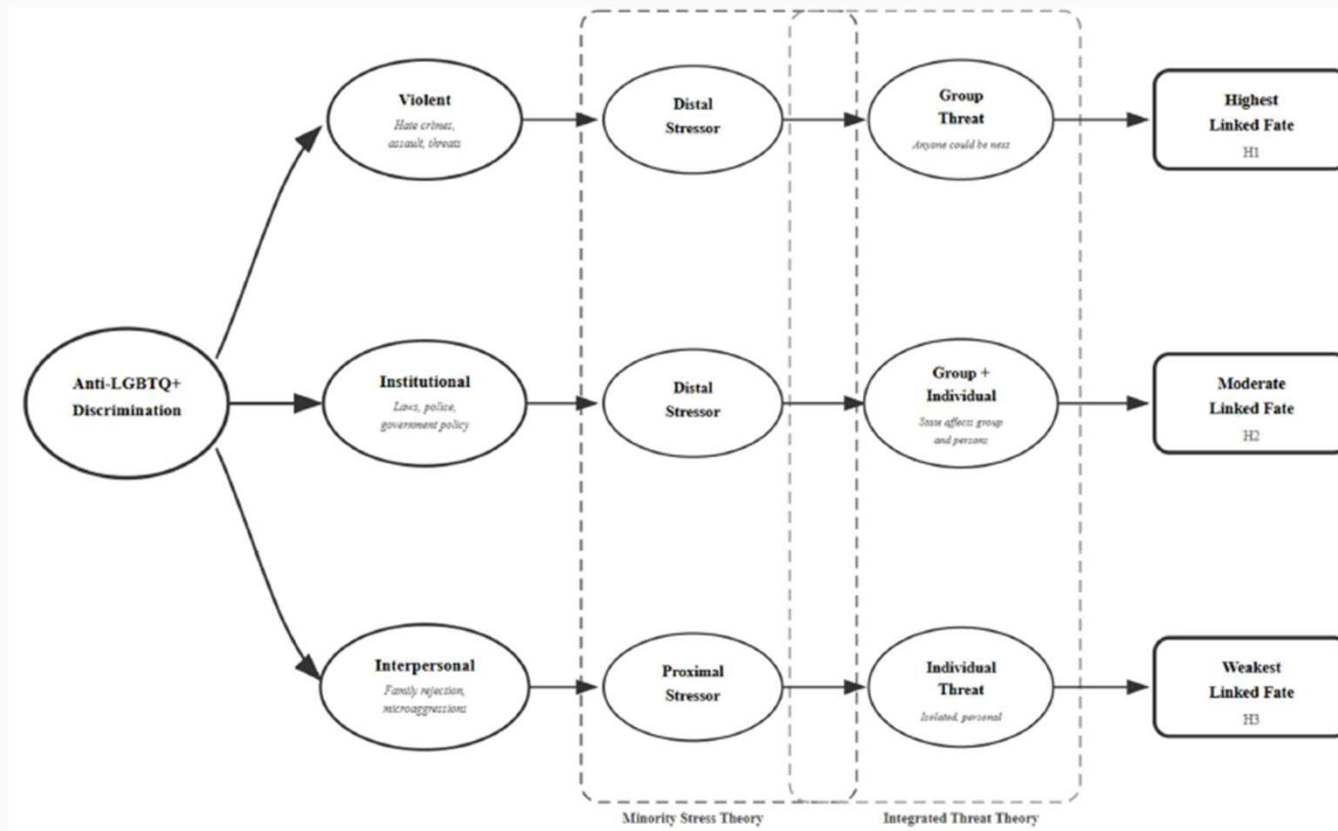
A Typology of Discrimination

- Each form activates both group and individual threat--- what differs is the proportion
 1. Violent---Hate crimes, assault, threats of bodily harm
 - Primarily group-level: individual violence signals community harm
 2. Institutional--- hostile law enforcement, discriminatory policy
 - Roughly balanced: state sanction (group) + material consequences (individual)
 3. Intimate--- family rejection, social exclusion
 - Primarily individual level: personal, private, isolated from collective meaning

Hypotheses

- H1: Perceived group-level threats will be associated with the highest levels of linked fate
- H2: Perceived institutional discrimination will be associated with moderate to strong levels of linked fate
- H3: Individual-level threats will be associated with weaker levels of linked fate

Theoretical Framework



Data

- 2024 Collaborative Multi-Racial Post-Election Survey (CMPS)
- N = 2,270 LGBTQ+ respondents; N = 1,932 in main specification
- DV: LGBTQ+ Linked Fate
 - How much do you think what happens to the LGBTQ+ Community will have something to do with what happens in YOUR life?
 1. Nothing to do with what happens in my life
 2. Only a little to do with what happens in my life
 3. Something to do with what happens in my life
 4. A lot to do with what happens in my life
 5. A huge amount to do with what happens in my life

Measuring Discrimination Types

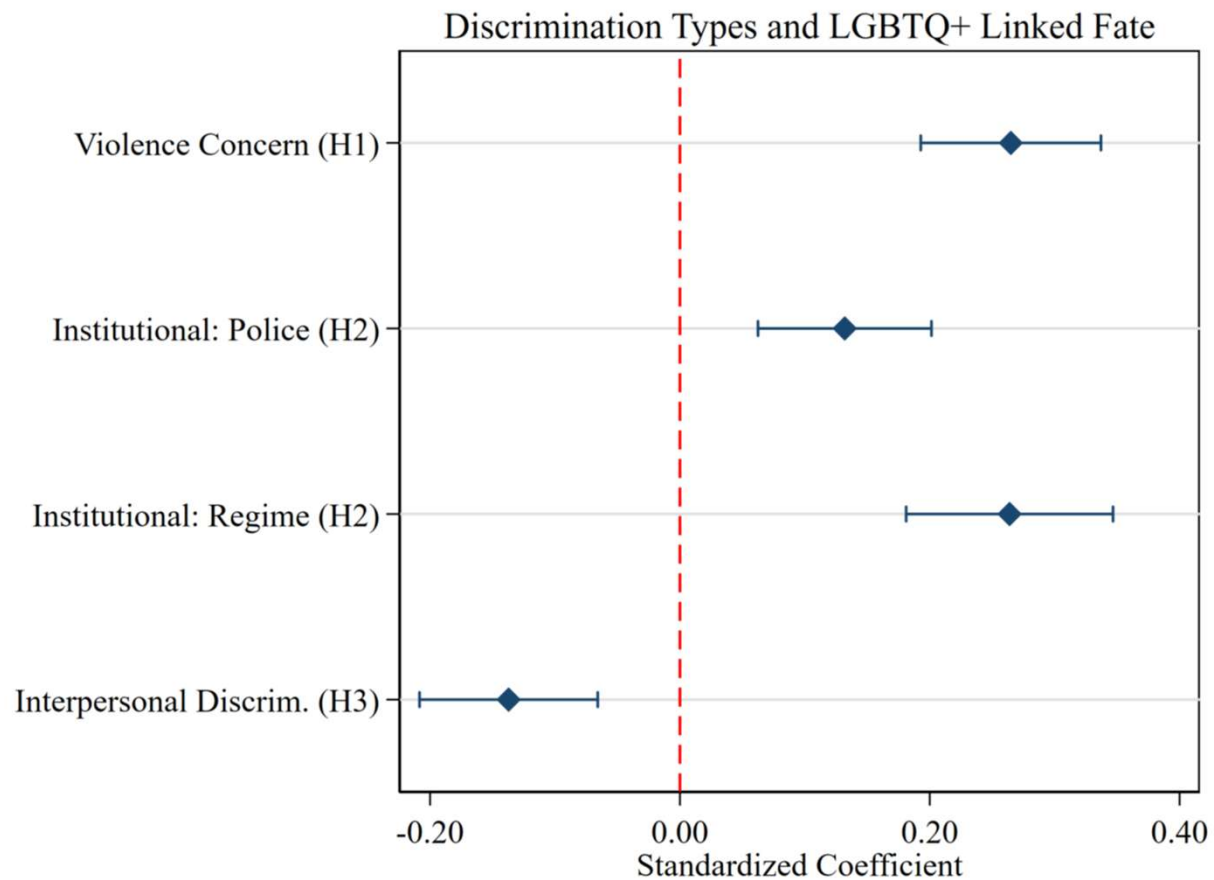
- Violence Concern (1-5)
 - “How concerned are you about hate crimes against LGBTQ+ individuals in your local community?”
- Institutional: Police Distrust (3-item index, $\alpha=.66$)
 - Police impunity, comfort calling police, trust in police protection (1-7)
- Institutional: Regime Pessimism (1-5)
 - “How confident are you that the Trump administration will protect LGBTQ+ rights?”
- Intimate: Family Unsupportiveness (1-6)
 - “How supportive is your family of your LGBTQ+ identity?” (1-very supportive, 5-very unsupportive, 6-not out (coded as most unsupportive))
- All IVs standardized for comparison

Estimation Strategy

$$LF_i = \beta_0 + \beta_1 \text{Violence}_i + \beta_2 \text{Police}_i + \beta_3 \text{Regime}_i + \beta_4 \text{Intimate}_i + \mathbf{X}_i' \gamma + \varepsilon_i$$

- OLS with survey-weights; robust linearized standard errors
- Models 1-3: each type separately
- Model 4: all measures simultaneously
- $\mathbf{X}_i$: gender, trans status, sexuality, race, age, education, income, ideology
- Robustness: Ordered logit, binary logit, subsample, alternative operationalizations

Main Results: Coefficient Plot



Main Results: Regression Table

	(1) <i>Violence</i>	(2) <i>Institutional</i>	(3) <i>Intimate</i>	(4) <i>Combined</i>
Violence Concern (std)	0.352*** (.037)			0.265*** (.037)
Police Distrust (std)		0.167*** (.036)		0.132*** (.035)
Regime Pessimism (std)		0.310*** (.041)		0.264*** (.042)
Intimate (std)			−0.122*** (.038)	−0.137*** (.036)
Controls	✓	✓	✓	✓
N	1,932	1,932	1,932	1,932
R ²	.194	.195	.138	.242

*p<.10, **p<.05, ***p<.01. Linearized SEs. Survey-weighted. All IVs standardized.

Key Takeaways

- Violence Concern: Strongest effect (+0.27 in combined models)
 - Group-level threat produces the most robust response for linked fate
- Institutional Discrimination: Significant on both dimensions
 - Regime pessimism (+0.26) and police distrust (+0.13) independently predict LF
- Intimate Discrimination: *Negative* effect (-0.14)
 - Family rejection *weakens* linked fate
 - Group atomization rather than collectivization

A Typology of Discrimination Effects

- **Collectivizing** Discrimination
 - Violent and Institutional threats
 - External, visible, shared
 - Clear boundary between in-group and out-group
 - Invites collective response
 - **Strengthens** linked fate
- **Atomizing** Discrimination
 - Familial rejection
 - Intimate, private, personal
 - Experienced as isolated incidents
 - Activates shame and withdrawal
 - **Weakens** linked fate

Why Might Intimate Rejection Differ?

- Familial rejection operates in a sphere that is **private**
- Activates shame and isolation rather than mobilization
- Despite it being a commonality amongst LGBTQ+ people, it is uniquely personal
- Consistent with MST: Proximal stressors operate through internal psychological processes rather than external
- Violent and Institutional discrimination are both public, they invite a collective response and provide common collective ground

To Conclude

1. **Discrimination is not Monolithic:** different forms activate group and individual threat in different proportions, producing divergent effects for solidarity
2. **MST + ITT in dialogue:** the theories complement each other nicely--- they describe different ends of the same continuum
3. **The Asymmetric Effect:** intimate rejection doesn't just weakly collectivize, it actively undermines solidarity

Thank You!

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<https://michaielelwell25.github.io/Elwell/>

Questions, comments, feedback?

Appendix

	(1) <i>Ordered Logit</i>	(2) <i>Binary Logit (OR)</i>
Violence Concern (std)	0.442*** (.065)	1.609*** (.134)
Police Distrust (std)	0.211*** (.057)	1.255*** (.093)
Regime Pessimism (std)	0.437*** (.070)	1.564*** (.139)
Intimate (std)	−0.225*** (.060)	0.807*** (.064)
Controls	✓	✓
N	1,932	1,932

* $p < .10$, ** $p < .05$, *** $p < .01$. Linearized SEs. Survey-weighted. Model 2 reports odds ratios; DV = high vs. low

Appendix

	<i>Top</i> <i>Not Out = 6</i>	<i>Drop</i> <i>Excl. Not Out</i>	<i>Mid</i> <i>Not Out = 3</i>
Violence Concern (std)	0.265*** (.037)	0.265*** (.039)	0.270*** (.037)
Police Distrust (std)	0.132*** (.035)	0.119*** (.037)	0.130*** (.036)
Regime Pessimism (std)	0.264*** (.042)	0.290*** (.043)	0.253*** (.042)
Intimate (std)	−0.137*** (.036)	−0.049 (.039)	−0.080** (.037)
Controls	✓	✓	✓
N	1,932	1,724	1,932
R ²	.242	.242	.235

*p<.10, **p<.05, ***p<.01. Linearized SEs. Survey-weighted. Codings vary treatment of “not out to family.”

Appendix

	<i>Factor 1</i> <i>(Police)</i>	<i>Factor 2</i> <i>(Regime)</i>
Police Impunity	0.80	−0.07
Police Comfort	0.57	0.55
Police Distrust	0.86	0.11
Trump Pessimism	−0.01	0.92
Eigenvalue	1.70	1.18
Proportion Var.	0.43	0.29

N=2,270. Principal-component factors, Varimax rotation

- Two factors retained (eigenvalues >1); 72% cumulative variance
- Police items load on Factor 1; Trump Pessimism loads on Factor 2
- Should be treated as separate dimensions of institutional threat: don't hang together well